

Sketching

You have all the data needed to start designing a user interface. Time to start sketching! This first step in creating the UI will ensure that the data collected from the user analysis, task analysis and function analysis is correctly reflected in the designed UI.

Sketching on a piece of paper is fast and easy. It will help you get good ideas and eliminate the bad ones. Once on paper, you'll easily understand where things such as options and menus need to be placed and how easy it will be for the user to get to them.

Wireframing

Wireframing is the next step in designing a UX-rich UI. While sketching gives you a rough idea for the creation of your UI based upon the analysis, wireframing gives you a rough guide for the layout of your product.

Wireframing is easy to perform. Neither do you need to know coding nor do you need to be good at graphic designing. There are readymade tools available with a drag-n-drop feature for creating wireframes, such as Mockingbird. These tools come preloaded with wireframed-UIs of various platforms.

Personas

A persona is depicted as a specific person, but is not a real individual. It's a fictitious identity which is synthesised from observations of many people. These people include the ones analysed previously.

It's very important for personas to reflect the pattern that you've identified in your user base. Keeping this in mind, you can design and present your persona by inventing details to make it believable.

Scenarios

A scenario is an imaginary story featuring one of your personas. It's the story of how your product fits into the life of your persona.

Storyboarding

Storyboarding is an effective way of capturing the how, why and when of someone using your product. This is represented in visual sequences of events showing the user's interaction with your product. The visuals can be anything from a hand-made rough sketch to an extremely polished comic-like design.

User testing

An actual user will play an important role in shaping the UX. In end-user beta testing, you'll ask a user to use your product and perform tasks planned for them.

This is a very straightforward approach, as you'll directly see how much the user struggles

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to use your product. Here, you'll know whether your design strategy was right, and if it wasn't, where it went wrong. And you can make the corrections accordingly.

UX Design Principles

Now that you know what goes into UX designing, it's time to look at the set of standard principles for UX design. These principles largely depend on the kind of product you're building. They may either be generalised rules or rules set by the company for its own product.

1. UX is a life cycle

People experience things over time. Not everyone likes a particular product all at once. They might not have a good experience with your product at first.



Ask a user to perform the tasks you've planned

Thus, user experience is a life cycle that includes creating awareness, setting up the first time use, getting into regular use and even depreciating it.

2. Context is king

It's easy to create a product, if you know how that product will perfectly fit into the user's life. It's thus necessary for a UX designer to carry out in-depth research about the product's user base.

3. UX is invisible

UX hides behind the UI. A user will rarely notice your hard work behind offering such a seamless experience. Therefore, as a UX designer prepare to be ignored despite any success you have – nobody talks about your success. All the credit will probably be given to the UI designer.

4. Great experiences are simple

We've often heard the phrase 'less is more', however, this isn't always true. UIs are shifting from